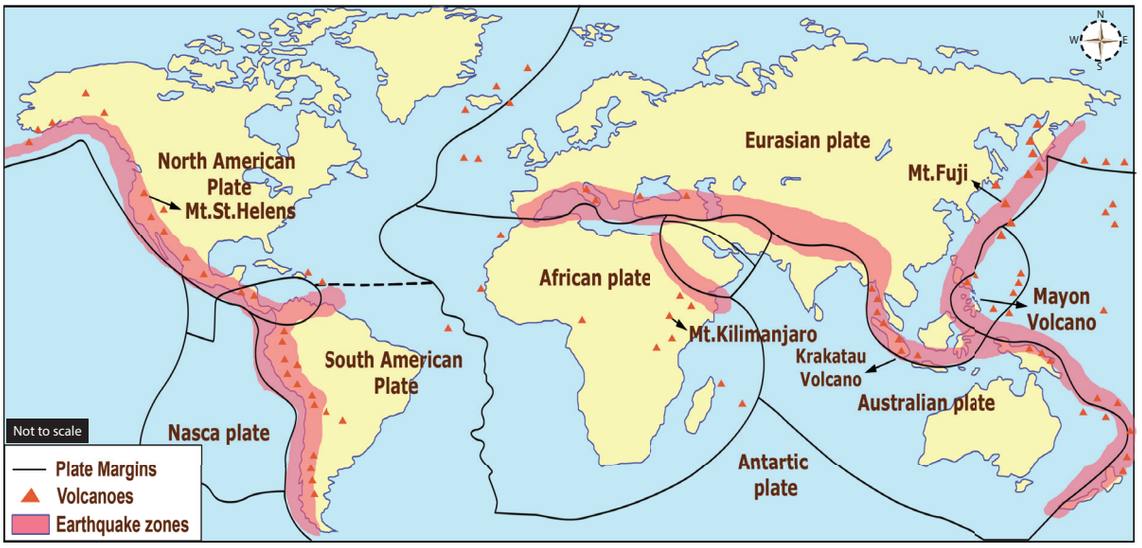


Figure 3.23 World Distribution of Earthquakes and Volcanoes

Japan, Philippines, New Zealand, west coast of North and South America. This zone accounts for 68% of all earthquakes on the surface of the earth.

2. Mediterranean-Himalayan region: This region extends from Alps mountain to the Himalayan Mountains and Tibet to China. About 31% of world's earthquakes occur in this region.
3. Other Areas: These include Northern Africa and Rift Valley areas of the Red Sea and the Dead Sea.

3.10 Volcano

A volcano is an opening in the earth's crust through which magma, gases and ash are released to the earth's surface. The molten rock material found in the interior of the earth is called magma. It can be noted that when magma reaches the earth's surface, it is known as lava (Figure. 3.25). Vent is an opening or mouth of a volcano. Fumaroles are the gushing fumes through the gap in the volcano. Crater is a saucer shaped depression in the mouth of a volcano. When the crater is widened, it is called as

CASE STUDY



Figure 3.24 Earthquake,Iran-Iraq border, 2017

On 12th November 2017, an earthquake with a magnitude of 7.2 on the Richter scale occurred on the Iran–Iraq border. Areas affected: Iran and Iraq.

Max. intensity: 8 (Severe)

Fault: Arabian and Eurasian plates. Casualties: 630 dead; above 8,100 injured; above 70,000 homeless. Depth: 19.0 km.

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